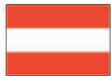


Austria



Bordering eight countries in the heart of Europe, Austria was created in 1918 after the collapse of the Habsburg Empire. Neutral after World War II, it joined the EU in 1995.



GEOGRAPHY

Mainly mountainous. Alps and foothills cover the west and south. Lowlands in the east are part of the Danube River basin.



CLIMATE

Temperate continental climate. The western Alpine regions have colder winters and more rainfall.



PEOPLE & SOCIETY

Though Austrians speak German, they like to stress their distinctive identity in relation to Germany. Vienna is a major cultural center. Minorities are few; there are some ethnic Croats, Slovenes, and Hungarians, plus refugees from conflict in former Yugoslavia. Though strongly Roman Catholic, Austrian society is less conservative than some southern German *Länder*. Class divisions remain strong.



THE ECONOMY

Large manufacturing base, despite lack of energy resources. The skilled labor force is key to high-tech exports. Eurozone membership since 2002 has boosted investment.



INSIGHT: Many of the world's great composers were Austrian, including Mozart, Haydn, Schubert, and Strauss



FACTFILE

OFFICIAL NAME: Republic of Austria

DATE OF FORMATION: 1918

CAPITAL: Vienna

POPULATION: 8.36 million

TOTAL AREA: 32,378 sq. miles
(83,858 sq. km)

DENSITY: 262 people per sq. mile

LANGUAGES: German*, Croatian, Slovenian, Hungarian (Magyar)

RELIGIONS: Roman Catholic 78%, nonreligious 9%, other 8%, Protestant 5%

ETHNIC MIX: Austrian 93%, Croat, Slovene, and Hungarian 6%, other 1%

GOVERNMENT: Parliamentary system

CURRENCY: Euro = 100 cents